R&AW chief R.N. Kao was deeply disturbed by the events unfolding in Bangladesh and dissatisfied with the MEA's explanations about the clumsy handling of Bangladesh affairs. The birth of this nation, largely attributed to the R&AW, had been followed by the near annihilation of Indian influence there and Kao was looking for an honest and realistic assessment of what went wrong. His career as an Indian intelligence stalwart was still intact and his team had worked wonders in 1971. So what happened after the warriors in the shadow left Bangladeshi soil was a wake-up call for Indian diplomats.

Kao's query resulted in a twelve-page assessment report which came close to the truth and even admitted the failures of Indian diplomats in Delhi and Dhaka. It ended with a recommendation for serious thought into the main purposes and functioning of Indian diplomacy.

The Bungling Diplomats

After the liberation of Bangladesh in 1971, India needed to choose the perfect diplomatic personnel to station in Dhaka and strengthen the delicate Indo-Bangladeshi relationship. The coup showed that the MEA had chosen wrong. Though the Indian establishment knew that following its birth as a nation, Bangladesh would be a storm-centre of high-pressure international politics and intrigue, it sent Subimal Dutta, an older gentleman, to Dhaka as India's high commissioner when a younger and more dynamic person would probably have faced the challenging situation there more effectively while ostensibly maintaining a low profile. The report that looked into the diplomats' failures said:

There were two personnel in the Indian diplomatic mission holding the third and fourth positions in the High Commission,